Inspection Report

R&R Chinchilla Inc

7754 State Route 103
Jenera, OH 45841

Customer ID: **9130**
Certificate: **31-B-0195**
Site: 001
R&R Chinchilla Inc

Type: FOCUSED INSPECTION
Date: 16-SEP-2026

3.125(a) **Repeat**

Facilities, general.

During the inspection of the facility in Building #1 Room 3 three adult chinchillas were observed free roaming through the animal housing area. The animals had escaped from their primary enclosures and did not appear injured. The animals were safely returned to their primary enclosures at the time of inspection.

Failure to secure animals in enclosures that safely contain the animals can lead to animal injury or escape from the facility. Correct by ensuring that the facility is constructed of such material and such strength as appropriate for the animals involved. The indoor and outdoor housing facility shall be structurally sound and shall be maintained in good repair to protect the animals from injury and to contain the animals.

3.130 **Direct** **Repeat**

Watering.

One adult mosaic chinchilla was excessively thirsty at the time of inspection in building 1 room 1. The animal was observed by the inspectors attempting to drink from an automatic watering receptacle that was not functioning. The animal did not have access to water and when water was provided the animal immediately approached the water receptacle and drank veraciously for approximately 35 seconds. The licensee stated that the animal was thirsty while APHIS personnel and the licensee were observing the animal drinking. The animal was housed in a row of 18 enclosures with 18 chinchillas and had an automatic watering system that was not functioning. The facility representative stated that the system was being replaced and was not functional since approximately 3:00 AM. The watering system was re-attached at the time of inspection and the remaining 17 animals in these enclosures did not excessively drink.

A lack of access to water can lead to dehydration, death, and can decrease milk production in lactating animals. Correct by ensuring that all animals are provided water as often as necessary for the health and comfort of the animal. Frequency of watering shall consider age, species, condition, size and type of animal.

3.131(a) **Direct** **Repeat**

Sanitation.

The facility is not adequately cleaning enclosures. Upon entry to Building #1 a strong smell of ammonia was experienced by APHIS personnel. In Building #1 Room 1 there were 4 primary enclosures housing 11 chinchillas with excessive fecal

Prepared By: MARK SANDERBECK
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Received by Title: Facility Representative
Date: 16-SEP-2026

material encompassing almost the entire floor area with minimal to no clean bedding. The primary enclosures have wire grate floors and the soiled bedding and excreta have risen above the level of the wire flooring resulting in the animals having to walk through excreta to gain access to the food and water receptacles. A primary enclosure housing a single chinchilla was observed in Room 3 with a dripping water line resulting in excessively wet bedding providing no dry space for the animal to lie down on the floor of the enclosure. The fur on the underside of the animal was wet and the skin in these areas appeared reddened and irritated.

Accumulations of feces, urine, and soiled bedding are harmful to the animals as they can spread disease, attract pests, and cause unpleasant odors. Additionally, due to this species' natural history an excessively wet and moist environment can be detrimental to the health and well-being of the animals. Excreta shall be removed from primary enclosures as often as necessary to prevent contamination of the animals contained therein and to minimize disease hazards and to reduce odors.

3.132 **Direct** **Repeat**

Employees.

There are an insufficient number of adequately trained employees to carry out the level of husbandry practices and care required by the Animal Welfare Act. There is one full-time employee, one full-time assistant, and a part-time assistant responsible for the care of approximately 1115 animals at this facility. There is a history of numerous and severe non-compliances identified pertaining to the cleaning, sanitation, watering, and veterinary care.

The issues seen are consistent with shortages of personnel. Insufficient personnel can lead to a failure in maintenance of the facility, delayed care for the animals, and unnecessary suffering and health concerns for the animals. The facility must ensure a sufficient number of adequately trained employees are utilized to maintain the professionally acceptable level of husbandry practices set forth in this subpart. Such practices shall be under the supervision of an animal caretaker who has a background in animal husbandry or care.

This inspection and exit interview were conducted with the facility representative.

You may appeal all or part of any inspection report by submitting a written statement contesting the findings—along with any supporting documentation—to the Deputy Administrator. Appeals of routine, focused, or attempted inspections must be received within 21 days of report issuance as shown by the signature line of this report.

Appeals may be sent by email to AnimalCare@usda.gov.

Appeals sent by mail should be addressed to:
Deputy Administrator
APHIS Animal Care (AC)
U.S. Department of Agriculture
2150 Centre Avenue, Building B
Mailstop #3W11
Fort Collins, CO 80526-8117

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Title: ANIMAL CARE INSPECTOR
Date: 16-SEP-2026

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Additional Inspectors:

Eric Irvin, VETERINARY MEDICAL OFFICER

Jonathan Tomkovitch, VETERINARY MEDICAL OFFICER

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United States Department of Agriculture
Animal and Plant Health Inspection Service

Customer: 9130
Inspection Date: 16-Sep-2026

Species Inspected

Cust No	Cert No	Site	Site Name	Inspection
9130	31-B-0195	001	R&R Chinchilla Inc	16-SEP-2026

Count	Scientific Name	Common Name
001115	*Chinchilla lanigera*	CHINCHILLA
001115	**Total**	